Era 19: Early Cold War

1945–1960 · APUSH Period 8 · Lessons 45–47

Name _____ Due _____

This is your study guide for the whole era. Complete each lesson section as you study it, using your class notes and textbook: read the AP topic(s) listed for the lesson in your textbook, define every term, person and event in your own words, then answer the Key Question in 3–5 sentences with specific evidence. Each lesson is checked and stamped in class; the whole guide is collected and graded at the end of the era. **Before the end-of-era test:** finish the Era Wrap-Up, then reread the whole guide. Fix or add anything in a different color.

Lesson 45 *Origins · containment · Marshall Plan · NATO*

8.2 (LO B): Explain the continuities and changes in Cold War policies from 1945 to 1980.

Read (AP topic in your textbook): Topic 8.2 *The Cold War from 1945 to 1980*

STAMP

Terms

Define it in your own words and explain why it matters.

1. **Iron Curtain**

2. **containment (George Kennan)**

People

Who they were and why they matter.

3. **Harry S. Truman**

4. **Joseph Stalin**

5. **George C. Marshall**

Events

What happened and why it matters.

6. **Potsdam Conference (1945)**

7. **Truman Doctrine (1947)**

8. **Marshall Plan (1948)**

9. **Berlin Airlift (1948–49)**

10. **NATO founded (1949)**

11. **Soviet atomic bomb & communist victory in China (1949)**

12. **Warsaw Pact (1955)**

Lesson 45 · Key Question *Origins · containment · Marshall Plan · NATO*

8.2 (LO B): Explain the continuities and changes in Cold War policies from 1945 to 1980.

Explain why the wartime alliance between the United States and the Soviet Union broke down and how containment shaped U.S. actions in Europe from 1945 to 1949.

Answer in 3–5 sentences. Make a clear claim, support it with at least two specific pieces of evidence from this lesson, and explain how the evidence supports your claim.

Lesson 46 *Korea · Red Scare · McCarthyism*

8.2 (LO B): Explain the continuities and changes in Cold War policies from 1945 to 1980.
8.3 (LO C): Explain the causes and effects of the Red Scare after World War II.

Read (AP topics in your textbook): Topic 8.2 *The Cold War from 1945 to 1980* · Topic 8.3 *The Red Scare*

STAMP

Terms

Define it in your own words and explain why it matters.

13. **NSC-68**

14. **HUAC**

15. **Alger Hiss case**

16. **McCarthyism**

17. **New Look**

18. **brinkmanship**

19. **domino theory**

20. **38th parallel**

21. **Hollywood Ten**

22. **Lavender Scare**

People

Who they were and why they matter.

23. **Douglas MacArthur**

24. **Joseph McCarthy**

25. **Dwight D. Eisenhower**

26. **John Foster Dulles**

27. **Julius & Ethel Rosenberg**

Events

What happened and why it matters.

28. **Korean War (1950–53)**

29. **Army-McCarthy Hearings (1954)**

Lesson 46 · Key Question *Korea · Red Scare · McCarthyism*

8.2 (LO B): Explain the continuities and changes in Cold War policies from 1945 to 1980.
8.3 (LO C): Explain the causes and effects of the Red Scare after World War II.

Explain how the Korean War and fears of communist spies fueled a Second Red Scare in the United States in the late 1940s and 1950s.

Answer in 3–5 sentences. Make a clear claim, support it with at least two specific pieces of evidence from this lesson, and explain how the evidence supports your claim.

Lesson 47 *1950s society · Eisenhower foreign policy*

8.4 (LO D): Explain the causes of economic growth in the years after World War II.
8.5 (LO F): Explain how mass culture has been maintained or challenged over time.

Read (AP topics in your textbook): Topic 8.4 *Economy after 1945* · Topic 8.5 *Culture after 1945*

STAMP

Terms

Define it in your own words and explain why it matters.

30. **Levittown**

31. **suburbanization**

32. **baby boom**

33. **Beat Generation**

34. **military-industrial complex**

35. **Sun Belt**

36. **television & rock and roll**

37. **The Affluent Society**

38. **The Other America**

39. **The Organization Man**

People

Who they were and why they matter.

40. **Nikita Khrushchev**

41. **Jack Kerouac**

Events

What happened and why it matters.

42. **GI Bill (1944)**

43. **Interstate Highway Act (1956)**

44. **Suez Crisis (1956)**

45. **Sputnik (1957)**

46. **U-2 Incident (1960)**

Lesson 47 · Key Question *1950s society · Eisenhower foreign policy*

8.4 (LO D): Explain the causes of economic growth in the years after World War II.
8.5 (LO F): Explain how mass culture has been maintained or challenged over time.

Explain the causes of economic growth and suburbanization after World War II and identify ONE group or critic that challenged 1950s mass culture.

Answer in 3–5 sentences. Make a clear claim, support it with at least two specific pieces of evidence from this lesson, and explain how the evidence supports your claim.

Era Wrap-Up *complete before the end-of-era test*

Containment in Action

Policy or event (year)	Where	What the U.S. did	How it contained communism
Truman Doctrine (1947)			
Marshall Plan (1948)			
Berlin Airlift (1948–49)			
NATO (1949)			
Korean War (1950–53)			

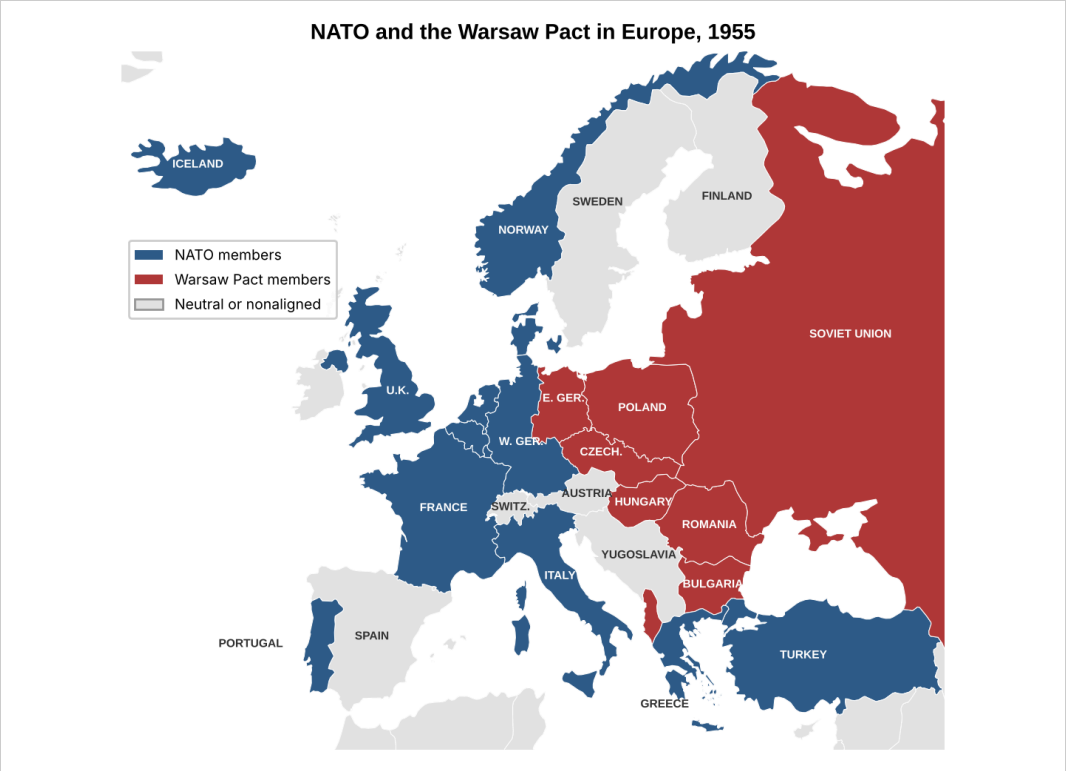
The Postwar Boom and Its Critics

Development	What it was	Who benefited / who was left out
GI Bill (1944)		
Levittown & suburbanization		
Baby boom		
Interstate Highway Act (1956)		
Television & rock and roll		

AP Short-Answer Practice

Answer a, b and c. Each part is scored on its own, so answer each one directly in 1–3 sentences with specific historical evidence.

Map: NATO and the Warsaw Pact in Europe, 1955



Map drawn for this guide from boundaries in the Historical Basemaps project (A. Ourednik); alliance membership as of May 1955.

a. Briefly describe ONE pattern shown on the map.

b. Briefly explain ONE historical development between 1945 and 1955 that led to the division of Europe shown on the map.

c. Briefly explain ONE way the division shown on the map affected United States foreign or domestic policy between 1945 and 1960.

DBQ Practice · Sourcing: Purpose

PROMPT

Evaluate the extent to which the Cold War changed American society from 1945 to 1960.

Your task: Write 2–3 sentences explaining the purpose of the speech in the document on this page and how that purpose is relevant to an argument that answers the prompt.

What earns the point: To earn credit, explain why the author created the document (here, a president asking Congress to approve $400 million in aid to Greece and Turkey) and how that purpose shaped its content and matters to your argument. Stating the purpose without connecting it to your argument is not enough.

Harry S. Truman, address to a joint session of Congress requesting aid to Greece and Turkey, March 12, 1947

At the present moment in world history nearly every nation must choose between alternative ways of life. The choice is too often not a free one.

[. . .]

I believe that it must be the policy of the United States to support free peoples who are resisting attempted subjugation by armed minorities or by outside pressures.

I believe that we must assist free peoples to work out their own destinies in their own way.

I believe that our help should be primarily through economic and financial aid which is essential to economic stability and orderly political processes.

Text: National Archives, Milestone Documents (transcript). Excerpt.

Connect forward — *Era 20 preview: the United States called itself the leader of the "free world" during the Cold War. Watch how civil rights activists used that claim to expose segregation at home.*